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Status report

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Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Morocco put artificial intelligence, digital transformation and administration reform under one ministry on 16 October 2026, when Ahmed Rahhou was sworn in as its minister in Fatima Ezzahra El Mansouri's new government, replacing Amal El Fallah Seghrouchni. Its weakest measured link sits inside its strongest: Effective Administration scored 62.0 out of 100 in 2023 and 16th of 54 African states, having moved 2.0 points over the decade while the Public Administration sub-category around it rose 13.3 points to 76.1 and 2nd of 54. The commitments above it are not thin. Digital Morocco 2030, launched in September 2024, is the third national digital strategy after Maroc Numeric 2013 and Maroc Numeric 2020, and covers e-government digitisation, interoperability, a unified portal, artificial intelligence and data governance; its stated targets are a 50% cut in administrative delays, a 40% simplification of procedural steps and first place in Africa with a top-50 global position in the UN e-government index by 2030, alongside targets for digital jobs and 3,000 start-ups.

Delivery was owned until October 2026 by the Ministry of Digital Transition and Administration Reform, which placed its data-centre and artificial-intelligence work under three standing frameworks — the strategy itself, the "AI Made in Morocco" roadmap and a national cloud roadmap for 2025-2030 — with a national cybersecurity strategy running to 2030 alongside them. The cloud roadmap is being executed as a Cloud-First policy, with the ministry and Oracle running a Cloud Computing Week in December 2025 to train public-institution administrators, and the AI roadmap through the JAZARI Institutes, presented in March 2026 with an Industry X.0 and health focus. Sovereignty is the register throughout: the minister casts digital transformation as a sovereignty lever (April 2026), and the DGSSI's director-general calls cybersecurity "a pillar of digital sovereignty" (June 2026). The GovTech Maturity Index records the transformation strategy as current rather than expired (2025).

Where the paper meets firms it thins out. Awareness of the public digitisation support programmes is low among Moroccan companies and take-up skews towards large, well-connected ones, leaving the SMEs that most need the help least served, on the World Bank's 2026 assessment, whose conclusion is that financing instruments alone will not digitise them without subsidised technical assistance, practical training and structured links between SMEs and technology vendors.

Legislation and regulation

The state is legislating the digital estate one sector at a time: draft law 52.26 on the national integrated health information system, 50 articles implementing chapter VIII of framework law 06.22, was adopted in Conseil de gouvernement in late July 2026. Statistics was recast the same month: law 047.26, promulgated on 28 July 2026, remakes the planning commission as an autonomous body with separate statistical and evaluation poles, taking effect only at its new steering committee's first meeting, and law 046.26 on the national statistical system cleared

the second chamber with it, unanimously, on 13 July 2026. Organic law 53.25, which carries the country's new electoral offences of digital and AI-assisted disinformation, passed both chambers in December 2025 and was found to contain nothing unconstitutional by the Constitutional Court on 24 December 2025; it bars alternative penalties for the electoral offences it creates, so custodial terms stand for all of them. A "Digital X.0" framework law binding data governance, digital identity and interoperability to traceable consent under Law 09-08 was with the General Secretariat of the Government in November 2025. A private member's bill to regulate artificial intelligence, running to 17 articles, reached the House of Representatives in January 2025. A second, bill no 53, tabled in the House of Councillors in April 2024, would create a national artificial-intelligence agency.

What is in force is older, written for administration rather than a digital estate. Law 24-96 on post and telecommunications covers last-mile access, internet resources and universal access; Law 35-06, promulgated by Dahir 1-07-149 of 30 November 2007, establishes the identity card, a 2020 decree mandating the electronic version from age 16. Service delivery rests on Law 53-05 on electronic data exchange, Law 55.19 on the simplification of administrative procedures and Law 54.19 on the public services charter, with Law 61.16 of 2017 creating the Agency for Digital Development, and Law 72-18 with its 2021 decree makes the Identifiant Civil et Social a mandatory interoperability key across public registers and social programmes. Personal data sits under loi 09-08 of 2009 and security under Law 05-20 on cybersecurity of 2020, which carries the only data-localisation requirement — sectoral, reaching public-sector and critical-infrastructure data rather than data at large (2025).

The distance between text and working system is the recurring hole. A decade separated the 2016 decree providing for an electronic platform for filing with the medical council from the platform opening in August 2026. Much working regulation sits below statute: decree 2.26.551 of 9 July 2026 overhauled the biometric passport system in place since 2008, and ANRT ran 5G licensing by competitive tender from July 2025.

Data protection

Morocco's police put live facial recognition on the street in July 2026, in the part of the state the data-protection law does not reach. The DGSN's Amane and Madar patrol vehicles entered field service in Rabat in the week of 20 July 2026, carrying 360-degree cameras that feed real-time number-plate reading, live facial recognition and direct access to the central police database, with 2030 World Cup readiness the stated driver. Article 2.4 of loi 09-08 excludes public safety, defence, national security and law-enforcement processing from the regime altogether, and the CNDP's facial-recognition moratorium recites that same provision in its own text, so it bound commercial and administrative use and never a security-service deployment.

Within its reach the law is conventional. Loi 09-08 classifies biometric data as sensitive and subject to stricter CNDP authorisation, gives a right of access and rectification, enforceable by complaint after ten days' silence from a controller, and restricts transfers of personal data out of the country; the CNDP, established by décret 2-09-165, has warned companies that breaches carry penalties. What is missing is the duty to tell anyone: controllers and processors are under no obligation to notify the CNDP of a personal-data breach, though notification is recommended (March 2026).

The regulator's powers have mostly been used on biometrics: a seven-month moratorium on facial recognition from 2 September 2019, issuing no authorisation for the technology at all, extended to the end of 2020, then case-by-case carve-outs for remote bank account opening and for social-protection proof-of-life checks. It also required vendor claims of not retaining biometric data past matching to be certified rather than accepted, and held that its own authorisation substitutes for no other approval — not Bank Al-Maghrib's, not the DGSSI's, not statute.

Two gaps have stood since 2012, when the Council of Europe's committee found law and authority in overall conformity with Convention 108 subject to two exceptions: sensitive data is defined without sexual life or criminal convictions, and specific legislation was asked for to cover the excluded files.

Regional collaboration

Morocco's standing in continental digital institutions is running well ahead of its measured integration: Regional Integration is its third worst-scoring IIAG indicator, at 26.2 out of 100 in 2023 and 44th of 54 African states, even after a 10.7-point ten-year gain. Over the same period it has been taking the seats. It was elected to the Administrative Council of the African Telecommunications Union for the 2027-2031 term at the union's Abuja conference in July 2026; it chairs the Smart Africa data exchange initiative and hosted eleven member states to co-create Africa's first cross-border data exchange guidelines (2025); and the DGSSI's director-general holds the vice-presidency of the African Network of Cybersecurity Authorities (June 2026).

The Abuja delegation combined the digital transition ministry, the regulator ANRT and the Agency for Digital Development, and it went to the continental membership with the national policy stack rather than a bid alone, presenting Digital Morocco 2030, the "AI Made in Morocco" roadmap and the cybersecurity strategy to 2030 and offering other African states access to its own digital institutions in cloud, artificial intelligence, data centres and digital services.

The bilateral record of 2026 is a set of light instruments: a digital-skills and capacity-building agreement with Gabon at GITEX Africa in April, a statement of intent with Ghana in May at the close of the African Open Government Conference Morocco hosted in Rabat on 5-7 May, and a meeting with the Digital Cooperation Organization's secretary-general in July at the UN Global Dialogue on AI Governance in Geneva. Two harder commitments predate them: Bank Al-Maghrib's accession to the pan-African payment system PAPSS in July 2025, and, much earlier, Morocco's request to accede to Council of Europe Convention 108, the one instrument that would bind its data-protection regime to a standard set outside the country, on which the Consultative Committee gave its opinion in October 2012.

Standards

Morocco's systems are being built to standards one sector at a time. The government interoperability framework was still in draft or planned rather than adopted on the World Bank's 2025 assessment, and the same index records no whole-of-government data governance arrangement that year. The standards that do bind are sectoral: health is building its own national interoperability framework to international clinical standards, validated through practical testing; interbank instant transfers run on an international messaging standard; open-data publishers work to a formats and metadata manual issued by the Agency for Digital Development; and the closest thing to a national architecture rule for identity is the data-protection authority's own position, set out inside a facial-recognition deliberation, that usage data and authentication data must not sit in the same architecture or with the same entity. Information security has a track of its own: the data-protection authority and the standards body IMANOR signed a convention in July 2021, for four renewable years, to adopt ISO 27001 and ISO 27701 as Moroccan standards and to train data-protection officers.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Morocco's electoral law sets prison terms for fabricating election content online. Article 51 bis of organic law 53.25, cleared by the Constitutional Court in December 2025, punishes with two to five years' imprisonment and a fine of 50,000-100,000 dirhams anyone who fabricates false or forged content, by any means including social networks and AI tools, with intent to harm the integrity of the electoral process; the tabled text had reached the spreading of rumours or false news. The Court held that the article does not touch press freedom or good-faith journalism

grounded in verification. Article 40 of the bill as tabled adds a jurisdictional offence with no analogue elsewhere in the law it amends: 50,000-100,000 dirhams for publishing paid political advertisements or electoral publications on foreign platforms or foreign electronic sites.

The civic ground this lands on has been giving way. Freedom of Association & Assembly fell 25.0 points to 25.0 between 2014 and 2023, the sharpest ten-year deterioration of any of Morocco's 96 IIAG indicators, with the Participation sub-category at 46.5 and Civil Society Space at 33.4 and 38th of 54 African states. Media Freedom stood at 44.3 and 39th of 54, and Deliberative & Participatory Governance at 65.1, slipping 2.0 points over the decade. The GenZ212 protests of autumn 2025 tested it: nearly 1,000 people were arrested, and on 4 October 2025 a first-instance court in Agadir sentenced a man to four years and a MAD 50,000 fine for inciting offences through social media.

The channels exist and the response is slow. Morocco has a right-to-information law rated effective rather than merely enacted, and a citizen participation platform in use that also carries petitions (2025). The ombudsman, the Médiateur du Royaume, opened close to 10,000 files in 2025, up more than a quarter on the year before, and reports that administrations delay or fail to answer his own correspondence despite a binding legal duty to cooperate with the institution.

Debate outside the institutions has been dominated by the border. Anonymous social-media calls for a mass crossing into Ceuta resurfaced for a third consecutive year in August 2026, directing prospective migrants into closed WhatsApp groups to coordinate, and neither researchers nor Spanish authorities have identified who launched the campaign. Two rights monitors analysed 1,245 posts, videos and comments across five platforms in five languages and found a surge of racist and xenophobic content targeting both the migrants and Moroccan communities across Europe, with women and girls appearing in crossing footage attacked over their appearance and "morality".

Finance

Financial sustainability

Morocco's own digital funds spent a fraction of the money they held in 2024: the telecommunications universal-service fund had MAD 4.17 billion available, carried-over balance included, and spent MAD 202 million; the fund for electronic identity and travel documents had MAD 2.74 billion and spent MAD 551 million; and the digital ministry's fund for administrative modernisation, the digital transition and Amazigh had MAD 2.74 billion and spent MAD 837 million (2024). What the universal-service fund has paid for is the core of the digital state, not only coverage: about MAD 300 million to the national population register, MAD 380 million to a secure high-speed state network, MAD 120 million to the national administration portal and MAD 400 million for two digital-transformation roadmaps paid to the Agency for Digital Development (2025).

The 2026 finance law holds the universal-service fund at MAD 200 million and the identity-documents fund at MAD 463.9 million, and cuts the modernisation fund to MAD 1.52 billion (FY2026), from MAD 1.72 billion in 2025 (FY2025). The digital ministry's own investment budget rose from MAD 11.7 million in 2021 to MAD 1.76 billion in 2024.

The four digital lines the 2026 finance law carries outside the ministries' general budget, the three special accounts and the interior ministry's digital-transformation service, come to MAD 2.26 billion appropriated, down from MAD 2.46 billion in 2025, the whole fall in the modernisation fund (FY2026).

The 2025 budget tables print no financing source against their digital lines (FY2025). The next external window is the World Bank's US$250 million programme approved in June 2026, which runs for five years. The state's own data-centre plans come with a running cost attached: the minister put the Dakhla data centre at about US$54 million to build and US$5.4 million a year to run, to be funded partly by the government, the Mohammed VI investment fund and the state deposit fund CDG (October 2025).

MoUs and other agreements

Morocco's digital transition ministry signed a memorandum with the US infrastructure firm Vertiv in Rabat on 27 July 2026 covering data centres, cloud, artificial intelligence and the power and cooling systems underneath them, with no sum attached and the instrument committing the parties only to exchanged expertise, technical studies and the identification of "structuring projects" — the scope the ministry's own communiqué gives it. That is the shape of most of what has been signed.

The exception on value is the memorandum Nexus Core Systems signed with the digital transition and investment ministries and the promotion agency AMDIE to launch an AI Factory Platform, announcing an initial investment of MAD 12 billion, about $1.2 billion at April 2026.

The rest is cooperation without money. The ministry signed the JAZARI-ROOT memorandum with Orange Morocco at the GenZ AI Summit in June 2026 to develop homegrown AI capability, and a memorandum with Capgemini Maroc on 17 July 2026 on AI skills across administrations, universities and research centres; with the data-protection authority CNDP it agreed in September 2025 to build a national responsible-AI platform on sovereign Moroccan language models. On the state-to-state side, Morocco signed a Statement of Intent with Ghana in May 2026, at the close of the African Open Government Conference in Rabat, on digital transformation and administrative modernisation, and an agreement with Gabon at GITEX Africa in April 2026 on digital skills and capacity-building. Operators do the same among themselves: Vodafone Business and Maroc Telecom signed a memorandum in April 2025 on joint enterprise digital services, and Orange Maroc renewed its partnership with Ericsson at GITEX in April 2026.

The Nexus memorandum is the largest single digital commitment on record for Morocco of any kind, public or private (2026). Across the six commitments the instruments are mixed: one development policy loan, two African Development Bank standard grants, one memorandum carrying private investment, and two World Bank operations whose instrument is not stated.

New investments

The World Bank approved and signed a $250 million (MAD 2.34 billion) Digital Transformation Acceleration Program in June 2026, a five-year operation to accelerate the rollout and take-up of user-centred digital public services and private-sector digitisation; it had not entered into force as at June 2026.

Everything before it went to inclusion and identity rather than to services. The Bank approved EUR 459.8 million (about US$500 million) in May 2020 under the First Financial and Digital Inclusion Development Policy Financing, a development policy loan behind the financial- and digital-inclusion reform agenda and the work around the National Population Registry, and its Board approved a US$70 million Second Identity and Targeting for Social Protection Project on 4 December 2024, building on the first project that designed the registry and the Unified Social Registry and extending the civil and social identifier into remote rural areas to 2028. Card issuance itself is not donor-funded: core national identity card operations run on the domestic police and interior budget, as does the e-government portfolio the Agency for Digital Development executes.

The African Development Bank's two Moroccan digital operations are both small: a grant of XDR 370,023.73 to establish an acquisition fund building a merchant electronic-payment acceptance network, aimed particularly at women merchants and at reducing cash in circulation, and a technical assistance grant of XDR 371,714.70 (USD 510,000) for the InsurTech, Inclusion and Innovation Programme, a USD 680,000 operation with USD 170,000 of counterpart funding from the insurance and social welfare supervisor ACAPS. The merchant grant was at pipeline stage in February 2026, while the InsurTech programme was launched with ACAPS in September 2026, to run until early 2027.

Six distinct digital-sector commitments to Morocco are on record for 2020 to 2028, from three financiers — the World Bank, the African Development Bank and the private firm Nexus Core Systems. The World Bank leads on both count and public money, with three of the six totalling about $820 million (2026).

Digital payments and fintech takes the most separate commitments, three of the six, ahead of one each for AI infrastructure, digital identity and civil registration, and govtech; by value the order inverts, and AI infrastructure dominates (2026). A decree in the official bulletin of 1 October 2026 approved the EUR 218.2m loan agreement for the programme.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Morocco's three mobile operators switched on commercial 5G in the country's major cities on 7 November 2025, and within six months the median 5G download speed had fallen 38%, from 266.94 Mbps in the first month to about 160-165 Mbps, while the 4G median fell 28% over the same period (2026). The regulator counted 3.2 million 5G users by March 2026, 8.4% of mobile internet users. The spectrum was awarded through a competitive tender run by the regulator ANRT in July 2025, and each licence carries a one-off fee and obligations to cover roughly 25% of the population by 2026, rising to 70% by 2030, which puts the coverage question on a clock the operators carry.

Seven months before switch-on, Maroc Telecom and Inwi had folded their long-running commercial dispute into two shared-infrastructure joint ventures, FiberCo for fibre and TowerCo for mobile sites, replacing litigation between the two largest networks with a joint build on the assets they hold together.

The underlying take-up is already unusual for the region. Some 91% of individuals used the internet in 2023, a gigabyte of mobile data cost USD 0.63 in 2024, below the UN affordability target of 1% of monthly gross national income per capita, and Morocco's IIAG score for Internet & Computers reached 91.6 out of 100 in 2023, first of 54 African states and up 46.1 points over the decade — the largest ten-year gain of any of the index's 96 indicators for the country. Public opinion moved with it, the index's perception-of-infrastructure measure reaching 78.4 out of 100 in 2023, third in Africa.

What has moved less is everything behind the last mile. International bandwidth stood at 134 kbit/s per internet user in 2022. Inland, the second operator Inwi offers wholesale a backbone of more than 9,000 km of its own and leased fibre, with 40 metropolitan rings and more than 2,000 buildings connected (October 2026), and domestic traffic exchange rests on two internet exchange points, CAS-IX in Casablanca and FEZIX in Fez, both with moderate participation (2025). Added capacity is going seaward: Nokia was selected in July 2025 to supply the optical transmission equipment for the Medusa subsea system linking North Africa to southern Europe. Rural reach runs on a separate national coverage plan, now in its second phase, under the 2007 post and telecommunications law that carries the universal-access obligation.

Data Storage

Morocco's sovereign and regulated cloud, the tier holding vital-activity, sensitive and strategic data, amounted to about 0.6 MW and MAD 30 million, roughly one-seventeenth of the public-cloud segment by load (2023). The public cloud serving unregulated firms came to about 10 MW and carried roughly 70% of all externalised Moroccan data, led by AWS, then Microsoft, then OVH (2023). The localisation regime therefore governs a fraction of what is already offshore, as the March 2021 fire at a Strasbourg data centre showed when it revealed several Moroccan national platforms serving citizens hosted outside the Kingdom.

The estate is small. The most recent measurement by the Moroccan state puts total installed capacity at 98 MW in 2020, up from 52 MW in 2014 — less than the 110 MW the same council attributes to South Africa's Teraco across seven sites alone — and outsourced hosting reached only 14% of it by 2020, from 4% in 2014. Tier III certification of the constructed facility went to the data centre of DXC Technology Morocco, a joint venture with the CDG group, in July 2024, in a sector Maroc Telecom leads; Orange Maroc added a 1.5 MW site at Nouaceur in November 2025 and AWS a Wavelength edge zone in Casablanca on 30 January 2025. Oracle brought a public cloud region at Casablanca into service on 7 April 2026, hosted by N+One Datacenters, with a second region planned at Settat. The state's own portfolio is far larger on paper: the project list the digital ministry presented in September 2026 would take national data-centre capacity towards one gigawatt, centred on a 100-hectare green campus at Dakhla with a potential 500 MW.

Government hosting is the gap. Morocco has a national data centre in operation and a Cloud First policy under Digital Morocco 2030, but the World Bank records a cloud strategy with no government cloud platform yet in operation (2025). The finance ministry's main data centre was certified Tier III Facility by the Uptime Institute in February 2025, which the ministry states is a first for the public administration. The rest is announcement: the ministry gives the Nexus AI Factory's first phase as 16 MW, and the planned 50 MW sovereign data centre at Rabat has no cost, date or financing established by the ministry itself. Its July 2026 memorandum with Vertiv carries no sum, committing only to expertise, technical studies and the identification of structuring projects, and the minister held separate talks the same day with N+One Datacenters and Cybastion: sovereign compute is being assembled as concurrent bilateral vendor relationships, not one procurement.

Taken together, the sovereign capacity announced since October 2025 would come to well over half the entire national estate as the state last measured it. A British firm announced its appointment to lead design management and procurement strategy for the platform's planned 20 MW facility near Casablanca (2026).

Energy

Renewables reached a record share of about a quarter of Morocco's power generation in 2024, which is what makes the grid interesting to data-centre developers rather than merely adequate for them. The adequacy is not in question: access to electricity is universal (2023), with no urban-rural gap, and firms reported an average of 0.2 outages a month in the World Bank's 2023 Enterprise Survey. Morocco's IIAG score for Access to Energy stood at 99.0 out of 100 in 2023, sixth of 54 African states, a ceiling reached partly through an off-grid electrification framework whose rural programme PERG had reached some 3,400 villages by 2018.

That combination — universal access, reliable supply, a rising renewable share — is being sold as an input to compute. The consortium behind the AI Factory has contracted several hundred megawatts of renewable supply from TAQA Morocco across the programme, a figure set against a national estate measured in tens of megawatts. New build is being tied to generation at the site: Orange Maroc's Nouaceur facility is powered in part by more than 1,000 solar panels, and agreements signed in November 2025 for a green data centre at Dakhla pair renewable power with natural cooling.

The power and cooling layer has become an object of state policy in its own right rather than a utility question left to developers: the digital ministry's July 2026 memorandum with Vertiv covers the electrical and cooling systems beneath data centres alongside the compute above them. Morocco's best-scoring IIAG sub-category is Infrastructure, at 85.8 out of 100 and first of 54 African states in 2023, up 17.4 points over the decade, and energy is much of why.

Technical Capacity

GitHub counted over 556,000 developers in Morocco in 2024, up 25% year on year from over 446,000 in 2023, a base that has grown without waiting on any state programme.

Against that, the systems the state runs itself still lean on foreign suppliers at the points that matter. The digital identity programme is operated by in-country DGSN technical staff but depends on a French vendor for credential personalisation systems and engineering support, and the national digital identity wallet is being built under February 2026 cooperation agreements with two further French firms. The flagship sovereign-compute project is capital-intensive rather than employment-intensive: its first phase at Nouaceur is planned to create a few dozen direct jobs, alongside a Centre of Excellence and an Innovation Hub.

Government's own measured readiness is uneven in a specific way. Public Administration is Morocco's second most improved IIAG sub-category over 2014-2023, second of 54 African states, yet Effective Administration is the weakest indicator within it, barely moving over the decade while the sub-category around it rose — the institutions have improved on paper faster than their capacity to execute. The same split shows in the statistical system, which the World Bank scores strongest on data services and weakest on data sources and data infrastructure (2023): the outputs are better than the machinery producing them. A public-service digital skills programme is in place, extending to advanced data science (2025).

Cybersecurity

Dozens of Moroccan institutions were among the victims of the FortiBleed Fortinet SSL-VPN credential leak, a global campaign affecting around 75,000 devices in some 200 countries, according to a maCERT/DGSSI alert of June 2026. The response was national and technical rather than declaratory: maCERT issued remediation guidance covering multi-factor authentication, password rotation and PBKDF2 password hashing. Cyber-defence is anchored by the DGSSI, which operates maCERT as the national computer emergency response team and issues public alerts to Moroccan institutions.

The legal frame is among the more developed on the continent. Under the 2020 cybersecurity law and its 2021 implementing decree, banking is classified a sector of vital importance, obliging banks and payment operators to report significant incidents to the DGSSI and its response team immediately, with financial penalties under Article 50. Bank Al-Maghrib puts the financial market infrastructures, including the interbank clearing system, through periodic external cybersecurity audits, summarising progress in its annual report while the audit reports themselves stay unpublished. Morocco scored 97.5 out of 100 in the ITU's 2024 Global Cybersecurity Index, placing it in Tier 1.

Designation of critical systems moves more slowly than the law implies. In March 2020 the data-protection authority referred to the DGSSI the question whether a national trusted-third-party authentication system should be designated an infrastructure d'importance vitale. Practice has been driven instead by incidents: Morocco reviewed and reinforced the security of its digital identity platform after the 2025 cyberattacks on the CNSS and the Ministry of Justice. Externally the posture is confident: Morocco presented a national cybersecurity strategy running to 2030 to the African Telecommunications Union in July 2026, and the DGSSI hosted the African Network of Cybersecurity

Authorities' executive leadership programme in Rabat in June 2026, its director-general holding the network's vice-presidency. At its Morocco Cyber Security Week in Rabat in October 2026, Liberia, Malawi, Lesotho, Mali and Egypt were admitted to the network, and Liberia agreed with the DGSSI to pursue a cybersecurity memorandum.

DPI

Data Exchange

The plumbing is running ahead of the rules meant to govern it: five core systems — customs, financial management, human resources, tax administration and social insurance — exchange data across a Government Service Bus alongside separate point-to-point interfaces, while the government's interoperability framework is still only a draft (2025).

The bus is not the only route. The Agency for Digital Development launched a national e-government interoperability platform in September 2022, built by Minsait, and not all government systems are connected to it; the Unified Social Registry and the MASSAR school management platform are among those that are. The agency's Jisr interoperability platform carried 55 million data exchanges through 46 interfaces in the year to January 2024. Health has begun building its own layer: a Mohammed V University e-health centre and the health ministry are developing a national interoperability framework, CI-SIS Morocco, on international clinical standards (May 2026).

Much of what moves, though, moves bilaterally and by negotiation. The tax register exchanges with other administrations under structured electronic data-exchange conventions, the Ministry of Justice and the DGSN signed their own agreement on electronic data exchange in 2024, and the DGSN's trusted third party platform lets public and private institutions check identity against the national card rather than hold their own copy of it.

What the layer has not delivered shows in the ombudsman's diagnosis of why Moroccans are still asked for the same document by one administration after another: he attributes it to weak coordination and weakly interconnected administrative databases, and calls for stronger inter-administration exchange alongside unified procedures (2025). Abroad the posture is more forward: Morocco chairs the Smart Africa data exchange initiative and hosted the work on Africa's first cross-border data exchange guidelines (2025).

Digital Identity and CRVS

The credential and the digital identity built on it are on different scales. The DGSN issued about 4.6 million electronic national identity cards during 2024, a record year, while users of the national digital identity platform were still counted in the millions by September 2025.

Holding the card is compulsory from the age of 16, on pain of a fine, and it is codified as proof of identity and nationality, replacing the birth certificate, the certificate of residence, the proof of life and the certificate of nationality. Records sit in a fully electronic central registry deduplicated by automated fingerprint matching, and the chip carries ten-print and facial templates, with liveness detection for remote authentication and no iris capture. The identifier behind it starts at birth: Law 36.21 on civil status, as consolidated with the amending Law 16.25 published on 29 January 2026, assigns the civil and social digital identifier at birth registration to every Moroccan and every foreign resident in Morocco.

What it is accepted for is broad. The DGSN's trusted third party platform runs under 17 framework agreements with more than 30 institutions, the credential is required to register for social assistance, banks' know-your-customer rules make it the primary identification document, and since a June 2023 agreement hospitals can verify patients through the scheme, though its use in health care is not compulsory.

The data-protection authority set out a different architecture from the one being built. In 2020 it held that national authentication should run through a single national trusted third party rather than multiplied authentication databases in either sector, that usage data and authentication data should not sit in the same architecture or with the same entity, with identification handled at sector granularity and any single identifier kept technical, non-public and tokenised, and it made the banking carve-out for facial recognition conditional on migrating onto that future system.

Citizens report the change: the Ibrahim Index's measure of the perceived ease of obtaining an identity document rose 30.6 points to 74.6 out of 100 in 2023, sixth of 54 African states and the fourth most improved of Morocco's indicators. The DGSN also ran 71 identity centres at missions abroad, issuing 219,408 cards to Moroccans overseas during 2024. In February 2026 the government signed cooperation agreements with iDakto and ShareID to build the national wallet on the IDEMIA foundations already in place.

Digital Payments and Fintech

The rails are scaling much faster than the public's use of them. Instant interbank transfers ran to 14.3 million operations worth more than 52.5 billion dirham by 23 July 2025, against 16.3 million worth 61.7 billion dirham in the whole of 2024, with average daily operations rising from 24,600 in June 2023 to 64,600 in December 2024 and a single-day record of 286,000 operations in 2025. Yet only 30% of Moroccans used digital payments, up from 17% in 2017 (2021), and access to banking services is Morocco's lowest-scoring business environment indicator on the Ibrahim Index at 38.1 out of 100 (2023) even while ranking tenth in Africa. Cash in circulation rose to 550.3 billion dirham at the end of August 2026, up 12.1% in eight months, and cash withdrawals made up 85% of the value of card transactions in 2025.

The infrastructure is complete and centrally held. Bank Al-Maghrib and the interbank clearing body GSIMT launched Virement Instantané on 1 June 2023, settling between banks in under 20 seconds, around the clock, on the ISO 20022 standard; the central bank runs the large-value gross settlement system itself and approves the governance and chief executive of the retail clearing operator under Law No. 76-03. Government money moves the same way: the treasury system is in use across ministries with payments settling through real-time gross settlement (2025), and Morocco has digitised the management and payment of its largest cash transfer programme.

Acceptance arrived through merchants rather than mandates: Attijariwafa bank opened QR-code acceptance of mobile payments to its corporate customers in June 2020, and the LabelVie retail group equipped every store for interoperable mobile payment with the interbank card centre in July 2020. The exception is tax, where electronic filing and payment by direct debit has been compulsory for all taxpayers since January 2017, and 91.2% of receipts were collected by remote payment in 2024. Bank Al-Maghrib cut the cap on domestic card interchange fees from 0.65% to 0.50% from 1 October 2026, with a 0.15% cap for government payments and local commerce. Cross-border, Bank Al-Maghrib joined PAPSS on 7 July 2025 as its seventeenth member country, without live transactions yet. The central bank's own diagnosis of what holds inclusion back is limited use of electronic payments, heavy reliance on cash and a large informal economy, bearing on women, young people and rural populations. A central bank working paper said a proof of concept built with the IMF and the World Bank confirmed the technical feasibility of a retail central bank digital currency, with any issuance a long-term prospect.

Registries

The electoral roll is the emptiest of the registers: Interior Ministry data for January to May 2026 show 16.5 to 16.8 million registered voters against an estimated potential electorate of around 28 million, some 12 million eligible citizens off the list, even though registration and consultation run online through the ministry's platform.

Civil registration is digital in its casework and paper in its law. Every civil registry office, rural ones included, records births, deaths, marriages and divorces through the SGEC case-management system, which had processed over 1.3 million acts by late 2024, while legally mandated physical registers are still kept alongside it and marriages and divorces are captured only as marginal notes on paper records (2025). The historic archive is being consolidated: over 38 million records back to 1915 into a unified national database. The law gives the register authority to share civil-status data, but permissively rather than obligatorily. Coverage is the strong point: registration extends to all vital events on Moroccan territory, and completeness for births stood at 96-97% in the last nationally representative survey (2018).

The National Population Registry, open to citizens and foreign residents alike, had enrolled more than 18.4 million people by the end of 2023. Its civic and social digital identifier is the key joining the social registry, the national agricultural register and the national handicraft register, though it does not reach across all government data, and the Unified Social Registry remains partially deployed as the single door to social assistance (2026). Its reach now runs past assistance: university grants for 2026-27 require the electronic identity card and the enrolment of the applicant's whole household in the registry, and beneficiaries are selected on the household's registry score.

Land is the least complete: about 30% of land is registered in the formal title system, concentrated in the cities, with the rural remainder under customary or unregistered tenure (2024), on a register operated digitally nationwide with online title verification; the land agency counts 7.7 million titles and serves 86 per cent of its 3 million users online. Addressing data was scattered across planning agencies, the land agency, utilities and the post (2021). Business registers are the most joined-up: the commercial register is maintained digitally by OMPIC, a common enterprise identifier is generated automatically once a company holds both its commercial court number and its tax identifier, and the DirectEntreprise single window, nationwide since March 2025 after a Rabat pilot of February 2023, had recorded more than 50,300 online company creations by May 2026, 44% of the year's new companies.

Sectoral management information systems

Every core government transaction system assessed for Morocco in the 2025 GovTech Maturity Index is in use — financial management, treasury, tax administration, customs, human resources, payroll, social insurance, debt management and e-procurement — which puts the back office materially further ahead than what a citizen can do with the state online.

Most of it is built rather than bought: tax is the only core system running on commercial off-the-shelf software, while the financial management system is custom, anchored on treasury execution and covering both central and local government, and human resources and payroll are custom too, with most HR services digitised for public servants (2025). Performance is where that system thins out, with indicators captured for selected programmes only.

Tax administration is fully digitised nationwide, with online attestations and a taxpayer identification number covering corporate tax, income tax and VAT, and the centralised Integrated Taxation System exchanges data with customs, the Ministry of Justice, the social security fund and the central bank. The constraint is registration rather than software: the tax authority identified 136,165 new taxpayers during 2023, 54.2% of them individual professionals and 45.8% legal entities, and the unique tax identifier is being made mandatory for all individuals between June 2026 and January 2027, required to open a bank account, complete notarial transactions, take out a telecom subscription or register a vehicle. Customs runs BADR, its own clearance system with electronic payment of duties.

Health is where the systems exist and the architecture does not. The national digitised health management information system was running in every public health centre in all regions by December 2019, with a patient-level electronic record still to be built, yet academic review finds health information systems fragmented and not

governed by an integrated national architecture (2025). Since 2025 the MOHIM programme has been building a sovereign national health interoperability framework aligned with HL7 FHIR, DICOM and SNOMED CT, validated through Projectathons, and the platform meant to carry a shared patient record was contracted in November 2024 for MAD 180.5 million to a consortium led by Mediot, with citizens to reach their records through the electronic identity card. Education went first: Massar has been mandatory nationwide since 2013 for enrolment, student identification, grades and absences, with data entered directly rather than compiled on paper. Labour is the newest arrival, the public employment agency having launched Veille+, a labour-market intelligence platform with AI features built with the ILO in May 2025. The government stated that the integrated hospital information system had been deployed in all public hospitals of the twelve regions.

The police explained the district management system in 2019: complaints and loss and theft declarations stored on a central server. Its 2023 review reported the rollout complete and linked to a criminal-case system piloted in 350 police posts. Crime-case management was added in 2024. The case system was networked in 16 of 22 police commands in 2025.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Morocco has started abolishing paperwork rather than digitising it. Instructions issued to walis and governors in July 2026 scrapped 22 administrative certificates outright — certificates of marital status, family relationship and inheritance among them — replacing them with sworn declarations, dropped certified copies and legalised signatures for most procedures, and barred any administration from demanding more than one copy of the same file. The Interior Ministry's own account is that citizens had been made to produce those documents with no legal or regulatory basis, and the enforcement hook is that only procedures published on the national Idarati portal are legally binding, on citizen and official alike.

The ombudsman finds digitisation was not accompanied by real procedural simplification: steps were moved onto platforms without reworking the process behind them, so people still produce physical documents or attend in person, and what the platforms publish does not always match what officials demand (2025).

The front door is thinner than the estate behind it. The national public service portal is rated informational only, level 1 or 2 of the GovTech Maturity Index's five (2025); the ministry relaunched it on 18 September 2026 as a unified access point to 874 online services and 2,533 published administrative acts, with a marketplace of AI tools attached. Dedicated portals for tax, social protection and employment are in use and the country counts more than 300 digital public services for citizens and more than 200 for businesses delivered through a programme of 89 projects carrying over 2 billion dirham of investment (2024). It ranked 90th in the world on the UN's 2024 e-government index.

The consolidation attempt is Idarati X.0, launched in February 2026 as a single entry point built around a digital wallet authenticated by the electronic identity card, with eight further institutions signed on; the wallet binds the social security fund, the road safety agency, the land registry and the ministries of Youth and Culture and of Transport. Identity-platform authentication is already live across the ministries of Justice, Habitat and Youth, the social security fund, the tax authority and the treasury. Individual services keep arriving alongside it, most of the identity card renewal moving online bar the biometric capture (May 2026), and the medical council putting doctors' registration and fees online in August 2026.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

The financial-management system does reach below the centre: it is in use, custom-built rather than off-the-shelf, anchored on treasury execution, and covers both central and local government (2025). Beneath that, the shared reference data local administration runs on is thinner — addressing data was fragmented across urban planning agencies, the land and cadastre agency, utilities and the postal service (2021).

Compliance at the local level has needed pushing. The Interior Ministry instructed walis, provincial governors and municipal council presidents to implement Law 55.19, having found that citizens were still routinely being made to produce the abolished certificates (2021).

Regional authorities in Casablanca-Settat told councils in May 2025 to drop their own software for the GIR-CT revenue system, with an e-filing and e-payment platform run with the treasury.

Rural digital data capture

Digital capture outside the capital is routine rather than aspirational: the Ministry of the Interior's civil registry case-management system is deployed across the Kingdom's civil registry offices, rural ones included (2024), the national school information system is mandatory nationwide and used in practice by rural primary schools (2024), and the national digitised health management information system runs in every public health centre (2019). Communication services had been extended to 10,660 of the 10,740 rural areas programmed under the national high-speed plan, with a second phase launched to reach 2,000 more by 2026 (December 2025).

The constraint is the conditions those systems run in. A rural-urban digital divide persists, a large rural population still facing connectivity and accessibility gaps despite the 2018-2023 plan to extend network coverage (2024). In Guelmim-Oued Noun, the electronic medical record improved coordination but added administrative burden, and telemedicine was held back by unreliable connectivity and slow maintenance (2025). Power is not the obstacle: rural electricity access matched the national rate (2016), on the back of a rural electrification programme reaching thousands of villages.

What is not captured is as telling. The formal land title system is concentrated in urban areas, the predominantly rural remainder held under customary or unregistered tenure (2024), and agricultural digitisation remains a target of the 2030 digital strategy (2024). Identity coverage is being pushed outward instead, a World Bank-financed second phase running 2024-2028 extending civil and social digital identifier coverage into remote rural areas through digital and remote applications.

The rural backdrop has been slipping. Rural Economy is one of only two Ibrahim Index sub-categories in which Morocco went backwards over the decade to 2023, down 1.3 points to 76.9 out of 100 though still 5th of 54 African states, with rural land and water access falling 14.2 points to 84.5; within it, the two support measures moved the other way, rural market access gaining 4.6 points to 72.4 and rural economy support 5.9 to 73.8 (2023).

Technology

AI

Morocco's first rules on artificial intelligence are electoral ones. Organic law 53.25, cleared by the Constitutional Court in December 2025, inserts a new Article 51 bis punishing with two to five years' imprisonment and a fine of 50,000 to 100,000 dirhams anyone who broadcasts a composition made from a person's words or likeness without their consent, or who publishes fabricated documents to intrude on the private life of a voter or candidate. The same

bill attaches a standing formula naming artificial-intelligence tools alongside social media networks, broadcast networks and electronic platforms to four separate offences, from polling-day publication to interference with freedom of the vote. Morocco has therefore legislated for AI without defining it, without a standalone AI offence and without a risk taxonomy, treating it as one more means of commission, and it places AI-assisted electoral manipulation inside the electoral code rather than in platform rules or a dedicated AI act.

Nothing of general application has been enacted. A private member's bill to regulate the use of artificial intelligence reached the House of Representatives in January 2025; a second, bill no 53, tabled in the House of Councillors in April 2024, would create a national artificial-intelligence agency charged among other things with curbing deepfakes; the digital-transition minister said in May 2025 that her department had drafted a framework bill on artificial intelligence; and a Digital X.0 bill placing AI governance, data governance and digital identity in one framework was still under government review (2025). What exists instead is programme, and since 16 October 2026 a ministry named for it: Ahmed Rahhou was sworn in as Minister of Artificial Intelligence, Digital Transformation and Administration Reform. On 8 September 2026 the digital ministry presented its "Maroc pour l'intelligence artificielle 2030" roadmap as moving into implementation, with targets of MAD 100 billion of added value to GDP, 50,000 direct and indirect jobs and 200,000 trained and certified people by 2030; the repository holds no roadmap document. Four JAZARI institutes held their general assemblies the same day, their constitutive conventions having been approved in the Bulletin officiel in August 2026, and on 30 September the ministry and Mistral announced their partnership's first tools, a classifier distinguishing Arabic dialects including Darija and a Darija speech-recognition model, to be released open-source.

Deployment is running ahead of the rulebook. Police patrol vehicles carrying live facial recognition and in-vehicle access to the central police database entered field service in Rabat (July 2026); the road safety agency was preparing camera and AI monitoring of driving-licence examinations (April 2026); and a national water digital twin is being built on a sovereign platform (July 2026); and customs launched a project with the World Customs Organization and Switzerland to apply artificial intelligence to risk targeting in May 2025. Ambition runs further out: the digital ministry and the data-protection authority CNDP agreed in September 2025 to build a national responsible-AI platform on Moroccan large language models trained on Moroccan language, culture, law and identity, while AI skills-building across the public administration and the universities is covered by a memorandum with a foreign integrator (July 2026) and the compute underneath is being assembled through several separate vendor relationships rather than one instrument.

ICT Industry

Fewer than one Moroccan firm in five integrates advanced technology intensively into its core operations (2024), and 31% of establishments use specialised business software while 8% have an enterprise resource planning system. Morocco sits near the median of the 18 countries the World Bank compares on firm technology adoption, and its distance to the global frontier is greater among its most advanced firms than among its least advanced (2024) — the gap widens where capability is highest. The Bank names managerial overconfidence as a barrier, the least digitised firms being the most likely to overrate their own capability (2026). The findings come from the 2026 Morocco Economic Monitor, whose special focus is incomplete digitisation, drawn from a 2024 survey of 1,256 manufacturing and services establishments.

The supply side is split by layer. Moroccan operators hold the physical estate — Maroc Telecom leads the data-centre sector, with Inwi, Medasys and N+One also present (June 2025), and Maroc Telecom and Inwi pooled fibre and mobile-site assets into two shared-infrastructure joint ventures (April 2025). Above it the suppliers are foreign: most externalised Moroccan data sits with AWS, Microsoft and OVH, and the national digital wallet is being built with two French identity vendors on IDEMIA foundations already in place (February 2026). Foreign firms also place research

here: Oracle inaugurated a regional research-and-development office in Agadir on 29 June 2026. The strongest domestic claim is the police's: the DGSN presents both of its AI patrol vehicles as Moroccan engineering and names no foreign supplier for the facial-recognition capability (July 2026).

Regulation is not the constraint. Morocco's Ibrahim Index score for business and competition regulations reached 74.6 out of 100 in 2023, 7th of 54 African states and 18.0 points up over the decade to 2023, and the registered developer base grew sharply through 2024. The weak link is transmission to the firms that need it: awareness of public digitisation support is low and take-up skewed towards large, well-connected companies, leaving SMEs least served (2026), against Digital Morocco 2030's stated targets for digital jobs and new start-ups.

Innovation ecosystem

Moroccan start-ups raised around $80m in venture capital in 2025, an established level of activity supported by multiple hubs and accelerators; AfriLabs lists 34 technology and innovation hubs in the country (2019). That activity has not yet moved the measured position: Morocco ranked 66th of 133 economies in WIPO's 2024 Global Innovation Index, up from 75th in 2020.

Public money now reaches start-ups through intermediaries. Decree 2.26.576 of 3 August 2026 authorised the state guarantee and financing company Tamwilcom to take stakes of up to MAD 347 million over three years in venture-capital funds on behalf of the Startup Catalytic Fund, with nine fund managers pre-selected and the selected funds expected to mobilise close to MAD 2.5 billion for Moroccan start-ups. No fund had been reported as capitalised or as having invested by September 2026. The telecoms operators are building alongside it: Orange Maroc and Technopark Maroc launched an "AI Garden" programme at GITEX in April 2026, offering AI start-ups cloud, connectivity, cybersecurity and use-case support, and two months later the digital ministry and Orange signed a JAZARI-ROOT memorandum to develop homegrown AI capability.

The state's own absorption of new things is being tested through sourcing rather than procurement. The 2026 GovTech Innovation Challenge invites Moroccan, Swiss and international start-ups to supply digital tools for public audit and public financial management, with the Inspection Générale des Finances and the Cour des comptes as the institutional users (July 2026), and the national data portal carries a register of Moroccan start-ups maintained by the digital development agency (January 2025).

Capacity

Literacy

Morocco's schools have expanded much faster than they have improved: over the decade to 2023, Education Enrolment rose 15.4 points to 75.4 out of 100, fourth of 54 African states, while Education Quality fell 7.5 points to 46.4, twenty-fourth, and the combined education score of 63.7 that places Morocco ninth in Africa (2023) is carried by the first of those and not the second. A system that is getting more children through the door while the teaching inside it slides is a poor floor for services that assume a reader who can follow written instructions unaided.

The gains are unevenly shared as well. Equality in education is one of Morocco's weaker placings in the same index (2023), and a wide gender gap in internet use (2020) means any service designed around a connected user reaches men more readily than women. The one thing that would settle whether the expansion is real — whether children finish school — is also the one thing the index cannot say: education completion is the single indicator for which it holds no data on Morocco at all (2023).

Learner records themselves are held in MASSAR, the national school management system, which is connected to the national interoperability platform (2024), so the administrative data exists inside government whatever the international series does or does not carry.

Training and skills

The state is buying its artificial-intelligence training in rather than building it: the Ministry of Digital Transition and Administration Reform signed a memorandum of understanding with Capgemini Maroc in Rabat on 17 July 2026 covering AI skills-building across public administrations, universities and research centres, support to JAZARI-backed start-ups, and public-service AI use cases, with no value, term or target disclosed. Beneath that sits a standing arrangement — the World Bank records Morocco as running a public-service digital skills programme with training freely available (2025) — and individual rounds surface where a vendor is attached, as when public-institution IT administrators were the audience for a cloud computing week run with Oracle in December 2025. Training is written into departmental job descriptions too: the manual for open data officers lists it alongside the data inventory, use cases and hackathons among their own tools.

Morocco is also exporting the function while importing the expertise. Its cybersecurity agency, the DGSSI, hosted the African Network of Cybersecurity Authorities' executive leadership programme in Rabat from 1 to 5 June 2026, and a bilateral agreement with Gabon signed at GITEX Africa in April 2026 commits the two digital ministries to work together on digital skills, capacity-building and artificial intelligence.

The domestic pipeline runs through tertiary institutions teaching ICT, Mohammed VI Polytechnic University among them (2023), and a network of technology and innovation hubs (2019). What absorbs those graduates is the weaker link: Digital Morocco 2030 carries targets for digital jobs and new start-ups by 2030 (2026), while the World Bank's reading of why Moroccan firms are slow to digitise is that financing instruments will not do it without subsidised technical assistance, practical training and structured links between smaller firms and technology vendors (2026). The security directorate and the World Bank opened an executive cybersecurity programme in Rabat for leaders of African cybersecurity authorities (2026).

Research institutions

The country's research base in this field is a small number of universities and specialist schools, Mohammed VI Polytechnic University among them (2023). What that base is for became a public argument in August 2026, when an essay on artificial intelligence put the test of technological sovereignty at productive research universities, sustained laboratory funding, trusted local data and models that understand Arabic and Amazigh, rather than at the ownership of data centres or imported applications.

Inclusion

Access to services

Equal Access to Public Services fell 2.7 points over the decade to 49.4 out of 100 in 2023, 20th of 54 African states — a measure of how far access varies between social groups, falling as the state's own systems expanded fastest. What a citizen meets explains some of it. The national public service portal publishes information about services rather than letting people transact through it (2025), even though dedicated portals for tax, social protection and employment are in use (2025). The ombudsman is blunter still: administrations moved existing steps onto platforms without reworking the process behind them, so people are made to produce paper or attend in person despite an electronic channel existing (2025), and what the platforms publish as the requirements does not always match what

officials demand when a file is actually processed. The national complaints portal Chikaya.ma took 163,694 complaints against public administrations in 2025, processing 66.14 per cent of them in an average of 16 days with a 58.69 per cent satisfaction rate.

In July 2026 a batch of administrative certificates was abolished outright and replaced by sworn declarations, the Interior Ministry stating that citizens had routinely been made to produce them with no legal or regulatory basis for the demand; certified copies and legalised signatures are dropped for most procedures, and under Law 55.19 only procedures published on the national Idarati portal are enforceable, on official and citizen alike. Social assistance runs through identity and social registers whose coverage is still partial (2024). For people outside the citizen path there is a documented route rather than parity: registration in the population registry is open to foreign residents as well as citizens, civil registration covers vital events on Moroccan territory whatever the nationality, and anti-money-laundering rules permit alternative means of identification, proportionate due diligence and remote onboarding, which leaves those without a national identity card a way to a payment account (2023). Disability is now measured as well as committed to: the third national disability survey put prevalence at 8.7 per cent of the population in preliminary results of September 2026, and found only 20 per cent of people with disabilities reporting internet access despite most owning mobile phones, with an employment rate of 12.7 per cent - 23 per cent of men against 4 per cent of women. What sits against that measurement is commitment: banks adopted an inter-banking charter in 2023 undertaking to make branches, ATMs and digital interfaces accessible to Moroccans living with a disability, and Digital Morocco 2030 sets universal accessibility of digital services for women, rural populations and people with disabilities as an objective (2024).

Digital divides

Morocco has closed its connectivity gap faster than almost any country on the continent without closing the gap between the people who use what it built: the September 2024 census found 59.6 per cent of people aged 15 and over using the internet in the previous three months, 64.4 per cent of men against 55.0 per cent of women, in a country where internet use is described as near-universal (2023) and where Internet & Computers is the most improved of the 96 indicators in its Ibrahim Index profile. Distribution has moved the other way. Inclusion & Equality is one of only two sub-categories of that index in which Morocco has gone backwards since 2014, down 1.5 points to 50.9 out of 100 in 2023, 22nd of 54 African states — the other being Rural Economy — and Equality in Education is among the weaker placings in the profile at 42.2 out of 100 in 2023, 35th of 54 and up 4.1 points over the decade, so the enrolment gains have not been even.

The rural line is the one the state has worked hardest and is still visible: the rural–urban divide in connectivity and accessibility outlasted the 2018–2023 plan to extend coverage (2024), the same census counting 70.2 per cent of people in towns using the internet against 40.4 per cent in the countryside, and a second phase of the national rural coverage plan was launched in December 2025. The affordability of a handset and a gigabyte is not what excludes people here; the habit is. Digital payments remain a minority practice (2021), which is why the national financial inclusion strategy, run by Bank Al-Maghrib with the Ministry of Economy and Finance, uses digital payments as its entry point and names women, rural populations and the unbanked as the groups it is aimed at (2023). The pattern repeats among firms: public support for digitisation is little known to them and taken up mainly by large, well-connected companies, leaving the smaller ones least served (2026). Official figures put more than a million Moroccans aged 15 to 25 in neither education nor work (2026), a cohort no digital service reaches by being online.

Data

National statistics

Morocco's score for the capacity of its statistical system rose 28.6 points over 2014-2023 to 88.7 out of 100, the highest of any African state, one of the five most improved of the 96 indicators the Ibrahim Index tracks for the country. On the World Bank's Statistical Performance Indicators for the same year (2023), the system scores above 89% on data services, sits in the 70-89% band for data use and data products, and is weakest on data sources and on data infrastructure, each in the 50-69% band. The producer is being reorganised: a statute promulgated on 28 July 2026 makes the Haut-Commissariat au Plan an autonomous body, splitting statistical production from strategic coordination, and comes into force only at the first meeting of its new steering committee.

The collection programme behind those scores is uneven. Over the last ten years Morocco has fielded three or more business surveys and three or more labour surveys, two household surveys and two agricultural surveys, but a single health survey (2023). A population census and an agricultural census have been run within ten years; no business census has been run within twenty (2023). Of the Ibrahim Index's 96 indicators, Education Completion is the single one for which Morocco has no data at all (2023).

Administrative records are filling some of the gap and leaving others open. The full historic civil register is being digitised into one national database (2024), but marriages and divorces are still captured as marginal notes on paper records while births and deaths are registered digitally (2025), and the most recent nationally representative measure of birth registration completeness comes from a 2018 household survey. The planning commission has begun to work the civil register as a statistical source: at the end of February 2026 it signed a framework agreement with France's national demographic institute centred on civil-registration data for the study of mortality and on its 2025 Family Survey. The employment agency ANAPEC has launched Veille+, a system for monitoring and anticipating the job market (May 2025), and an e-invoicing rollout in preparation is to route invoicing data to the statistics office alongside the central bank and the social security fund. Where the state does hold the data, dispersal is the binding problem rather than technique: the case for the national water digital twin rests on water data sitting across separate institutions rather than on any deficiency in modelling capability (July 2026). The World Bank made incomplete digitisation of Moroccan firms the special focus of its 2026 Economic Monitor, drawing on a firm-level technology survey.

Open data

Publication in Morocco is the standing duty of a designated Responsable Open Data inside each public body, backed by an annual open-data activity plan and a monitoring-and-evaluation plan rather than left as an IT task; the same manual puts the data inventory, training, use cases, hackathons and innovation events in the officer's own remit. A companion manual for data managers carries the publication workflow, kept separate from those accountability rules; a methodological guide of February 2023 tells bodies how to enumerate what they hold; and the formats and metadata standard is set by an operational manual at version 1.1 of December 2024.

Four ADD operating manuals issued between April 2021 and December 2024 — accountability, publication workflow, data inventory, and formats and metadata — put the whole procedure in writing, making this one of the few African open-data programmes assessable against its own documented procedure rather than only against portal statistics.

The Agency for Digital Development runs the national portal, data.gov.ma, with several hundred datasets, and runs user-satisfaction surveys and data-quality assessments under the World Bank-backed ENNAJAA programme (2024). Its documentation section records a national open-data action plan and named working groups owning the

national data inventory and the metadata standard (August 2026). Some of it is administrative rather than reference material: a register of Moroccan startups known to the agency went up in January 2025, on a portal the GovTech Maturity Index records as publishing basic information and datasets (2025).

Coverage is strongest on poverty and income, education facilities and labour, at 8.5 out of 10 each, and weakest on pollution at 5.0, gender statistics and reproductive health at 5.5, with crime and justice, food security and health outcomes at 6.0 (2024). What is not published can be asked for: the right to information law is rated effective rather than merely enacted (2025), and the Ibrahim Index puts accessibility of public records at 67.4 out of 100, 2nd of 54 African states, while disclosure of public records reached 53.2, up 26.1 points over the decade (2023). Morocco hosted the African Open Government Conference in Rabat in May 2026.

Use of satellite data

Satellite feeds are one input to Morocco's national water digital twin, which fuses them with sensor and basin-agency data on a sovereign platform hosted in the country, at the EHTP scientific tower with LPEE and CID, running hydrological, hydraulic and hydrogeological models with AI set to accelerate analysis and auto-detect territorial change rather than replace the models (July 2026). No pilot had yet run as at July 2026.

Weather forecasting is the established use: the meteorological directorate switched from Meteosat Second Generation to Meteosat Third Generation data in January 2025, and its forecast chain combines satellite images every ten minutes with some 430 automatic stations and 44 observation centres (December 2025).

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

Morocco is assembling its sovereign compute from several parallel American vendor relationships rather than awarding one integrator: on the day of the Vertiv signing the minister held separate talks on the same ground with N+One Datacenters and with Cybastion, Vertiv itself also present. The instrument at the centre of that day was a memorandum of understanding signed in Rabat on 27 July 2026 between the Ministry of Digital Transition and Administrative Reform and Vertiv, covering digital infrastructure, cloud, artificial intelligence, high-performance computing, data centres and the electrical and cooling systems beneath them — a scope reaching every layer of the state's compute plans, and an agreement to work together rather than a contract to build. Spreading the work across suppliers spreads commercial risk, but where each supplier answers to the same jurisdiction it does not spread legal exposure.

The commercial layer arrived ahead of the ministerial one. AWS made a Wavelength Zone generally available in Casablanca on 30 January 2025 in partnership with Orange, putting a hyperscaler edge node on Moroccan soil and giving latency-sensitive workloads a local landing point. Oracle opened a public cloud region in Casablanca on 7 April 2026, which it describes as the first hyperscaler public cloud region in North Africa, and plans a second at Settat with no timeline. Oracle inaugurated a regional research-and-development office in Agadir on 29 June 2026, an opening attended by Prime Minister Akhannouch and the US ambassador — the diplomatic weight in the room being the notable part, since no headcount or research mandate came with it. Iozera, a US firm, has announced a data-centre build at Tetouan (June 2025).

China activities

No Chinese vendor contract, investment or intergovernmental agreement in Morocco's digital sector had been recorded as at August 2026.

EU activities

Morocco's digital identity credential runs on French supply at both ends of its life. In February 2026 the government signed cooperation agreements with the French firms iDakto and ShareID to build a national digital identity wallet, the wallet being the layer through which a citizen will present the credential; the credential itself is produced on card personalisation systems supplied, with engineering support, by IDEMIA of France (2026). A state that holds the register and the staff can still find the presentation layer and the production line both sitting with foreign vendors, and that is where Morocco sits.

The other European presence is in the ground and the seabed. Nokia was selected to supply the optical transmission equipment for the Medusa subsea cable (July 2025), the AFR-IX Telecom system linking North Africa, Morocco among the landing countries, to southern Europe.

Gulf/UAE activities

In December 2023 Morocco and the United Arab Emirates exchanged 12 investment-cooperation memoranda in Abu Dhabi, one of them on data-centre projects with a first phase of 100 megawatts, a prospect of nearly 500 megawatts and incentives for investment in the field still to be explored. No contract or investment arising from that memorandum was on record as at September 2026.

India activities

Morocco and India agreed in Rabat on 24 August 2026 to establish a joint commission on artificial intelligence and language technologies, starting with systems that handle several languages and dialects in dealings between citizens and the administration, building on the two ministers' meeting in New Delhi in February 2026. The older Indian link is in identity: Morocco signed an MoU in 2018 as the first adopter of MOSIP, the open-source identity platform Nandan Nilekani's team in India built on Aadhaar's core ideas, and had registered 22 million of its 39 million people in the national population register by June 2026, which was helping 5 million eligible households reach social programmes.

Digital sovereignty

Morocco has written control with portability into its cloud rules for critical systems, and had qualified no provider under them by September 2026. Decree 2-24-921, published in February 2025, obliges entities of vital importance that put sensitive systems or data in the cloud to use a qualified provider, its higher level requiring majority Moroccan ownership, processing, storage and supervision exclusively on national territory, and Moroccan operating staff; a provider leaving the service must return the systems or data, then delete them and certify the deletion, and the decree takes effect only once the order fixing the qualification standard is published. The cybersecurity agency's register of regulated services listed qualified audit providers and no qualified cloud provider (September 2026).

Law 05-20 requires any outsourcing of a sensitive information system to run under a contract governed by Moroccan law with commitments on auditability and reversibility, and Oracle's Casablanca region is hosted in N+One's facility to meet that article, while the AWS Wavelength zone in Orange's Casablanca data centre has Paris as its parent region. Government hosting is still a plan: the minister described the 2025-2030 cloud roadmap as a Cloud First migration of the public sector to compliant cloud, a sovereign cloud, a national marketplace of certified cloud offers operated by the Agency for Digital Development, and strategic alliances with the hyperscalers (November 2025).

The national population register was built on MOSIP, an open-source identity platform, with Moroccan staff developing and operating it (2026). Whether the state holds the source code and operating skills for the identity card's personalisation systems, or can exit its operating contract, was not on record as at September 2026.

The AI layer is being built on the same terms: the AI marketplace the ministry presented in September 2026 is designed so that data stay protected and the infrastructure is controlled in Morocco, beside a Software Factory pooling reusable software components across administrations. The terms on which the Nexus AI Factory and Vertiv memoranda govern data jurisdiction, portability and exit had not been published as at September 2026.

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